ThemeBot

PRODUCT PLAN · 1 OCTOBER 2026

Desktop app and web app: the plan

One engine, two products, built by one person with AI. Desktop first: it sells in 2 weeks. The web app follows and launches in April 2027.



Desktop app

first sale **Oct 19**
full version **Jan 11**



Web app

private beta **Mar 1**
public launch **~Apr 12**



$220–840 / month

in bills while we build
(servers, database, AI, tools)

2 weeks
desktop v1 (both plans)

~4 weeks
both first versions (speed run)

11 vs 27 weeks
everything: speed vs normal

Week 0 = Monday 5 October 2026. Built by one person working with AI. Bills use each vendor's published price on 1 Oct 2026; your own time is not included. Dates follow the normal plan unless marked speed run. **ESTIMATE** marks planning numbers.

1 · TODAY

Where we are

The engine works. One store still needs to pass the quality check from start to finish.

Engine

- ✓ Reads the website
- ✓ Builds the Shopify theme
- ✓ Shows live progress
- ✓ Uploads to a draft theme
- ✓ Rebuilds only what's missing
- ✓ Tracks AI cost
- … Quality check & fixes
- – One store fully passed

Desktop app

- ✓ Runs on our computer
- ✓ Guided store setup
- ✓ Uses their own AI account
- ✓ Right-store check
- … Client list
- – Installer
- – Licence keys

Web app

- – Sign-up & teams
- – Building online
- – Cheaper AI engine
- – Plans & credits
- – Connect a store
- – Shopify approval

Not started yet.

✓ done … partly done – not started

117 / 117	16	41 / 42	~$45
sections built on the test store	pages on the test store	automatic tests passing	AI cost per store build today

Next step: get one store to pass the check with no hand edits. Everything else depends on it.

Six phases, about 6 months

One person, one thing at a time. ◆ = something we can sell or launch.



Oct 19
Desktop v1: first sale

Jan 11
Desktop v2: full version

Mar 1
Web app private beta

~Apr 12
Web app public launch

How the recipe stays ours

Desktop app = the hands
Works on the customer's computer: their browser, their files, uploading to their store.

⇄

Our server = the brain
The recipe, the building steps and the quality scoring. It never leaves our server.

The web app uses the same brain; its hands run on our cloud. Until the brain is ready (January), desktop v1 is protected by the licence and the contract.

Late December is slower (holidays). If you take time off, Desktop v2 moves into mid-January and the rest moves with it.

Fast track to a first sale

A simple Windows desktop app for 1–2 friendly agencies by **Friday 16 October**.

WEEK 1 · PROVE IT, PACKAGE IT

Day 1 · Mon 5
Prove it
Run the test store until it passes

Day 2 · Tue 6
Prove it
Fix what breaks

Day 3 · Wed 7
Prove it
Record cost & time

DEADLINE
Day 4 · Thu 8
Go / no-go
Passed? Start packaging

Day 5 · Fri 9
Installer
One-click Windows install

WEEK 2 · MAKE IT SELLABLE

Day 6 · Mon 12
Licence keys
Using a ready-made service

Day 7 · Tue 13
Safety switches
Ownership box, draft-only, store password

Day 8 · Wed 14
Setup wizard
Folder, AI account, store

Day 9 · Thu 15
Fresh-PC test
Install & build from zero

FIRST SALE
Day 10 · Fri 16
First agencies
Hand over, fix issues

Decide on day 1

- Product name
- Normal pace or speed run
- Payment provider
- Which 1–2 agencies test it

Left out for now

- Signed installer · shows a warning
- Automatic updates
- Mac version
- Credits & the cloud brain

Watch out

Day 4 is the real deadline. If the store hasn't passed by then, use week 2 to fix the engine. Don't sell before it passes.

Sell only to agencies that sign the contract; v1 carries the recipe.

Can it be done in a month?

First versions of **both apps in about 4 weeks**, on a 60-hour week (5 days × 12 hours). Everything finished: about 11 weeks instead of 27.

Speed run

60 h a week · no buffers

Wk 1	**Prove it + Windows installer**	One store passes; one-click install
Wk 2	**Desktop v1 to first agencies ◆**	Licence keys, setup wizard, safety switches
Wk 3	**Web app first version**	Sign-up, connect a store, build queue; customers use their own AI account
Wk 4	**Web private beta ◆**	Subscriptions, error reports, backups, ~5 users
Wk 5–9	**Cloud brain + desktop v2**	Credits, recipe stays on our server, signed installer, Mac
Wk 10–11	**Public launch ◆**	Help pages, support, App Store submitted

Normal pace

40 h a week · with buffers

Wk 0–2	**Desktop v1 ◆**	Same as the speed run
Wk 2–5	**Protect & sell**	Recipe sent per build, terms, sales page
Wk 5–11	**Cloud brain**	Lower AI cost, credits
Wk 11–14	**Desktop v2 ◆**	Signed installer, Mac, updates
Wk 14–23	**Web app, beta at wk 21 ◆**	Accounts, online building, credits
Wk 23–27	**Public launch ◆**	Help pages, support, App Store

What speed gives up

- Web app starts on customers' own AI accounts; credits come in week ~9
- Fewer test stores before the beta
- No room for sickness or holidays

What doesn't speed up

- Shopify's App Store review
- Installer identity check
- Customers' feedback
- Whether the first store passes

What gets delivered

- **Week 2:** desktop v1 in agencies' hands
- **Week 4:** web app private beta
- **Week 11:** both apps launched

If we take the speed run: plan a lighter week after each ◆ to fix what the first customers find. The next page shows where speed pays off.

5 · WHAT A RUSH REALLY SAVES

Where speed helps, and where it doesn't

AI writes code fast. Most of ThemeBot's time goes to testing on real stores, and more hours don't make that part faster.

Desktop v1 in 2 weeks If a store passes the check by day 4	Rush works
Web app first version in 4 weeks For a few beta users; expect about a week of fixes after	Works, with fixes after
Lower AI cost & credits Needs many real test builds, and each one takes hours	Rush doesn't help
Signed installer, Mac, App Store Waiting on Microsoft, Apple and Shopify	Rush doesn't help

Problems we only found by testing on real stores

Wrong store picked
Setup chose another account's store

Surprise Shopify pop-up
A new screen stopped the setup

Build stopped halfway
A restart cut a long build short

False "limit reached"
A warning showed when nothing was wrong

Old details remembered
Store data from a previous account

Each one was quick to fix once we saw it, but we only saw it by running real builds. A rush runs into the same problems with less time to fix them, and sometimes in front of customers.

If we rush everything

- First agencies meet the bugs
- Time moves from building to fixing
- Harder to win trust back

If we rush only desktop v1

- Something real to sell in 2 weeks
- Real feedback guides the web app
- Each release works the first time

Suggested approach: move fast on desktop v1, then keep a steady pace. The first agencies will remember whether it worked more than how fast it arrived.

Desktop app milestones

Phase 1 · Desktop v1

wk 0–2 · Oct 5 – Oct 16

1. One store passes end to end
2. Pick your own work folder
3. Customer build without our developer tools
4. Windows installer
5. Licence key screen
6. Setup wizard + terms to accept
7. "I own this site" checkbox
8. Store password setting; never publish live by default

Done when 1–2 agencies build a store with it on their own PC

Phase 2 · Protect & sell

wk 2–5 · Oct 19 – Nov 6

1. Recipe sent per build, removed after
2. Licence re-check, device limit, revoke on refund
3. Terms, privacy and refund policy checked by a lawyer
4. Cost estimate + cost limit per build
5. "Send logs to support" button
6. Sales page + checkout
7. Founding-agency offer (first 10)
8. 1–2 done-for-you client stores a month

Done when 3 agencies have paid and the recipe no longer stays on their PCs

Phase 4 · Desktop v2

wk 11–14 · Dec 21 – Jan 8

1. Cloud-brain mode: credits or their own AI key
2. Keep "own AI subscription" mode as an option
3. Signed installer (no warning)
4. Automatic updates
5. Mac version
6. Client & project history, extra seats

Done when agencies install, update and buy credits without our help

Protection grows by phase: contract only (v1), then recipe sent per build (phase 2), then the recipe never leaves our server (v2).

Engine and web app milestones

Phase 3 · Cloud brain (for both apps)

wk 5–11 · Nov 9 – Dec 18

1. Recipe and build steps run on our server
2. Desktop app carries out the server's steps
3. Cheaper AI for simple steps
4. Overnight builds at half price
5. Credit meter + spend limit per account
6. Same quality as v1 on 5 test stores

Done when a store passes the check for about $20 or less in AI

Phase 5 · Web app

wk 14–23 · Jan 11 – Mar 12

1. Sign-up, log-in, teams & roles
2. Building on our cloud (the web "hands")
3. Connect a Shopify store in one click
4. Plans, credits, checkout, invoices
5. Build queue and plan limits
6. Monitoring, daily backups, security review
7. Apply for Shopify approval (week 14)
8. Private beta: 10 users from Mar 1

Done when 10 beta users build without our help, each build at about 50% margin

Phase 6 · Launch

wk 23–27 · Mar 15 – Apr 9

1. Public launch of the web app
2. Shopify App Store listing + review
3. Help pages + short how-to videos
4. Support process and response times

Done when anyone can sign up, pay and build without talking to us

Shopify's review sets the App Store date, not us. The web app can launch on our own site first and join the App Store when approved.

The monthly bills

Prices from each company's pricing page on 1 October 2026. Your own time is not included.

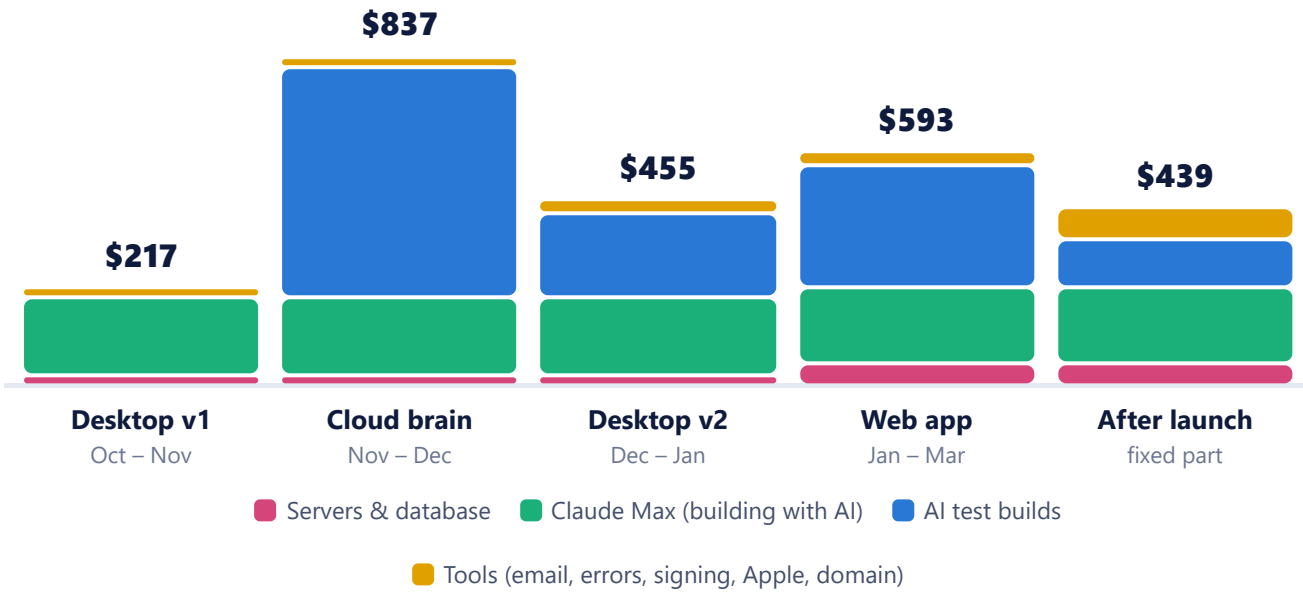
SERVICE	WHAT IT'S FOR	PRICE	DESKTOP	WEB
SERVERS & DATA				
Hostinger VPS · KVM 2 2 CPU · 8 GB · 100 GB	Licence & recipe server; later the web app itself	$8.99/mo 2-year prepay · renews $14.99	**$8.99**	**$8.99**
Hostinger VPS · KVM 4 4 CPU · 16 GB · 200 GB	Build server: runs customers' builds online	$12.99/mo 2-year prepay · renews $28.99	—	**$12.99**
Supabase Pro 8 GB database · 100 GB files	Accounts, log-in, customer data	$25/mo 100k users included	—	**$25**
Cloudflare R2	Theme files & screenshots	first 10 GB free then $0.015/GB	—	**~$0**
AI				
Claude Max	The AI you build the product with	from $100/mo 5× and 20× usage tiers	**$200**	**$200**
Claude API	AI for the cloud brain & credits	per build ~$45 today → ~$18 target	**per build**	**per build**
OpenRouter	Cheaper AI for simple steps	5.5% on credits bought	**~$20**	**~$20**
PAYMENTS				
Lemon Squeezy	Checkout, licence keys, sales tax handled for us	5% + 50¢ per sale	**per sale**	**at start**
Stripe	Web subscriptions once volume grows	2.9% + 30¢ +0.7% Billing · +0.5% Tax	—	**later**
TOOLS				
Resend	Sign-up & receipt emails	free 3,000/mo then $20 for 50,000	**$0**	**$0 → $20**
Sentry	Crash & error reports	free 5k errors Team $26/mo	**$0**	**$0 → $26**
Google Workspace	Business email	$7/user/mo	**$7**	**$7**
Azure Artifact Signing	Signed Windows installer (no warning)	Basic tier price not shown, confirm (~$10 budget)	**~$10**	—
Apple Developer	Mac version can be installed safely	$99/yr	**$8.25**	—
Domain	themebot-style web address	~$12/yr estimate	**$1**	**$1**



Lock Hostinger's price: the low rates need 2 years paid upfront: about $216 now for KVM 2 and $312 in January for KVM 4. Monthly billing costs more.

What we pay, month by month

About **$220 a month** now. It peaks near **$840** while the cloud brain is tested, then about **$600** while the web app is built. Each customer build adds its own cost.



Each customer build costs us

BUILD	AI	SERVER	TOTAL
Web app build	~$18	~$0.25	**~$18**
Desktop, cloud brain	~$18	~$0.05	**~$18**
Desktop, their own AI	$0	~$0.05	**~$0**
Any build today	~$45	—	**~$45**

Plus payment fees on each sale (Lemon Squeezy 5% + 50¢). One KVM 4 server runs a few builds at once.

ESTIMATE

One-off & upfront costs

ITEM	WHEN	COST
Hostinger KVM 2, 2 years	Oct	~$216
Hostinger KVM 4, 2 years	Jan	~$312
Apple Developer	Dec	$99/yr
Lawyer: terms & contract	Oct	~$1,500 est.

The Hostinger prepay is the same money as its monthly figure, paid early.

Oct → Apr total: about $3,500 in monthly bills plus about $1,600 one-off (lawyer ~$1,500 estimate, Apple $99). That's roughly **$5,100** to get both products launched, before your own time. ESTIMATE

Why not everything in 2 weeks?

AI writes code in days. The time goes to proving it works, waiting on other companies, and letting customers try it.



Where the time goes ESTIMATE



Builds take hours

The AI builds a store in hours, not seconds. Testing 10 stores takes days.

It must pass the check

No store has fully passed yet, and we don't know how many fix rounds it takes.

Shopify sets its own pace

App Store review and approvals take weeks. We can't speed them up.

Certificates & payments

The installer certificate and payment account need outside approval.

One person

You build, sell, support and deliver client stores. Each one takes time.

Taking money safely

Billing and online building must be tested before strangers pay.

Short answer: AI makes the coding fast, which is why desktop v1 sells in 2 weeks. On a 60-hour week, both first versions arrive in about 4 weeks and everything in about 11. Testing, Shopify's review and customer feedback don't speed up with AI.

What could go wrong

One person does it all

Biggest risk. Cap client stores at 2 a month and protect build days.

Store doesn't pass

Everything waits on day 4.

AI costs too much

Keep credits off; sell licences and the service.

Recipe copied (v1)

Contract-only sales until the cloud brain.

Shopify is slow

Launch on our own site first.

AI rules change

Re-check provider terms before each launch.

Decisions we need from you

- Product name & domain
- Approve the prices
- Payment provider
- First 1–2 agencies
- Lawyer for the contract

Bottom line: first desktop sale Oct 19. Desktop v2 with the protected recipe Jan 11. Web app beta Mar 1 and public launch around Apr 12. Bills run about $220–840 a month. On the speed run, both first versions are out in about 4 weeks.